# Where Does Mom Need Help Today?

A worksheet for what you've seen since she went into the hospital.

The therapist asks what Mom could do on her own before the hospital, and what she can do now. You know the answer. You've just never had to put it into words.

Write what you've seen yourself, with the day. Add to it over several visits; it doesn't need to be done in one sitting.

A visit shows you only part of her day. If you haven't seen something, write “haven't seen” and leave it. That's a question for the staff, not a blank you have to fill.

## Before the hospital

What Mom did on her own in an ordinary week before this stay, and where someone already helped.

**FOR EXAMPLE** Lived alone and cooked for herself. Used the stairs every day. Denise set up her pills on Sundays and did the heavy shopping.

## Everyday activities: what you've seen this week

Bathing, dressing, eating, using the toilet, getting in and out of bed or a chair, walking. Write what you saw her do, and what you saw the staff do for her.

**FOR EXAMPLE** Wednesday, lunch: fed herself once the carton was opened. Two aides helped her from the bed to the chair.

## Memory, thinking and time on her own

What you've noticed, and anything about her safety that worried you, written as what you saw or heard, not what you think it means.

**FOR EXAMPLE** Tuesday: asked twice which day it was. Knew all the grandchildren's names. Used the call button when she needed the bathroom.

## Medications and treatments

Who managed her medications before this stay, and anything you've been told is new. Write your questions here, and change nothing yourself.

**FOR EXAMPLE** Mom took her own pills from the box before. A nurse mentioned a new one in the evening and I didn't catch the name. Ask.

## What I haven't seen

The parts of her day you aren't there for: nights, bathing, therapy sessions. List each one as something to ask a nurse or a therapist.

**FOR EXAMPLE** Haven't seen her walk further than the bathroom. Don't know what nights are like. Ask the night nurse and the physical therapist.

## Who filled this in, and on which days

**What this shows you**

Three things: what Mom did before, what you've seen her do this week, and what nobody in the family has seen yet. It doesn't show what level of care she needs or where she should go. Nothing here adds up to a score or a level, and the clinical questions, such as medications, therapy or anything that worries you, go to the people caring for her. Nothing here is medical, legal, financial or tax advice.

### Ready for the next step?

You've written down what you've actually seen, and what you haven't seen yet. The care interview picks up from there: it asks about Mom's situation one area at a time, so nothing important is left out, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

**Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›**